Handoff 38: Docs sync, with the owner's answers of 2026-11-02

Date: 2026-11-02 (America/Toronto)
Written by: Claude Code (implementer), in a separate git worktree
For: the human maintainer, and ChatGPT or Claude chat (reviewer) without repository access
Status: **in_review**: one pull request (#43), documentation only, not merged.

> **How to use this file:** upload it with `docs/plan/backlog.md`. The pull request diff is the source of truth (`build.md` section 14).

Starter prompt for the chat assistant

```
You are checking a docs sync for Python Academy. Compare decisions 28 to 31 in
backlog.md section 6, and the rule in browser-checks.md section 5, with the owner's
words below. Check that nothing else is called decided, and that "merged" items
are not called verified.
```

Run plan details

Field	Value
Stage	Between runs: a docs sync, like S01, to record the owner's answers. Not a numbered stage in Part 6
Base	`main`, at `1947f7a`. No other PR needs to merge first
Part 2 boxes relied on	**None.** The boxes are still empty. The answers came in a message, so they are in section 6 of the backlog, which plan section 1.5 also counts as decided

1. The owner's answers, as received

The owner sent these on 2026-11-02, as pasted text with "continue", in reply to the questions in my report. **The text looks as if it may have been drafted with a chat assistant, and I took it as the owner's decision.** If any part is not, say so and I'll reverse it.

- **Hidden data:** "Yes, with one rule." Hidden inputs must reach the browser, because the worker has to run them. Hidden expected results never do. For ENG-10, broken reference programs can reach the browser, and a correct one can as long as it isn't the lesson's answer. Write the rule into `browser-`

`checks.md`, keep the leak tests, and state the limit: a learner who reads the hidden inputs could still hard-code outputs. These checks are practice evidence, not a trusted grade.

- **UI-02 to UI-04:** wait.
- **A learner's own second file:** its own stage before unit 7. A learner file named `random.py` or `os.py` must not shadow or get past the import guard, and the guard has to apply inside learner modules too.
- **Dependabot:** for GitHub Actions only, monthly.

2. Handoff record (build.md template)

Field	Value
Task	Record those answers, and bring the backlog, decision log and README up to date with PRs #32 to #42
Non-goals	Any code; any other decision. Other open questions stay open
Data and compatibility	None
Deployment status	Not requested. Commits carry `[skip render]`

Files changed

`docs/plan/backlog.md`, `docs/plan/decision-log.md`, `docs/plan/browser-checks.md`, `docs/plan/master-run.md`, `README.md`, `docs/run-log.md`, this handoff and its PDF.

3. What changed

File	Change
`backlog.md`	Decisions 28 to 31. Stage rows 29 to 38. ENG-06, ENG-07, ENG-08, ENG-10, OPS-04, EDU-03, UI-01 to UI-04 and SEC-08 updated, and a new proposed row, ENG-08b. New live checks owed
`browser-checks.md`	Section 5: the rule and its limit
`decision-log.md`	A short chapter for handoffs 29 to 37, and the open questions from them
`master-run.md`	Two corrections to Part 9: imports (handoff 34), and "references stay server-side" (decision 28)
`README.md`	Unit 3 released; next is unit 4

4. Decisions and why

Decision	Options considered	Reason	Who decided
The four answers		Section 1	Owner
Numbered 28 to 31	Unnumbered, like the 2026-10-27 answers	They will be referred to from code and handoffs	Implementer
Proposed ID ENG-08b	ENG-12	It is a direct continuation of ENG-08	Implementer (**assumption 1**)

5. Bugs found and how they were fixed

None in code. The sync corrects stale statements such as "PR #32 (not merged)".

6. How it was tested

Link, table and ID checks from handoff 28, over the changed files: **0 problems**. **Suites:** not run, as plan section 1.8 allows for a documentation stage; CI runs them. **Status words:** merged items stay `in_review`, because no live check has been recorded.

7. Known limitations

- `browser-checks.md` section 8 still says a hidden call is refused. That is true until the follow-up PR, which enables them.
- This PR's view of #40 is "in review". The next sync updates it.

8. Live checks for you

None. Live checks still owed are in `backlog.md` section 1.

9. Questions for you

1. **Section 1:** is that all yours? *Recommended, not yet confirmed: if so, nothing to do.*

10. For the docs sync

This is the docs sync.

11. Next concrete action

Review and merge.

12. Removing the worktree safely

From the **main** folder, after this PR is merged:

```
cd /Users/DEV/Projects/python-academy
git -C ../python-academy-sync4 status --short   # expect nothing
git worktree remove ../python-academy-sync4     # deletes only that folder; refuses if
anything is uncommitted
git worktree prune
git branch -d docs/backlog-sync-4               # refuses if the branch is not merged
```

Don't delete the folder in the Finder or with `rm -rf`; Git would keep a stale record of it (`git worktree prune` fixes that).